Lesson plan · for the teacher

# Passphrases you can remember

Cyber safety · Level 1 · Lesson 1

**Time**
40 min

**Materials**
Board and chalk (or paper on the wall); About 20 word cards on scrap paper, in a bag or tin; A real padlock, or a drawing of one with number dials; Worksheet: Password power (one per pair, optional)

## Learning goals

- Explain why three random words are harder to guess than a name and a birthday.
- Build a practice passphrase from three random word cards and remember it.
- Name three things we never share with friends or callers: a password, a PIN and a one-time code.

## Activity: Passphrase builders: Word cards

1. Warm-up (5 min): Show the padlock with three number dials. Ask how many combinations a thief would need to try, then how many with six dials. Write 1,000 and 1,000,000 on the board.
2. Teach (8 min): Point to “Musa2012”. Explain that guessing programs try names, birthdays and common tricks first. Pull three cards from the bag, write the passphrase, and draw one funny picture that links the words.
3. Word cards (12 min): Pairs pull three cards, write a practice passphrase and draw one picture linking the words. Cards go back in the bag. At the end of the lesson, pairs try to recall their words from the picture alone.
4. Pair talk (8 min): Read out four situations: a friend asks for your password; a caller asks for a code sent to a parent’s phone; one password for everything; a list kept safe at home. Pairs decide “safe” or “not safe” and say why.
5. Wrap-up (7 min): Pairs look at their picture and try to recall their three words. Then exit ticket: one rule for a strong passphrase and one thing they never share.

**Write about 20 everyday nouns on small cards — mango, bucket, rocket, drum, sandal, cloud — and mix them in a bag. On the board, write “Musa2012” and draw a padlock with three number dials.**

## Discussion

- What makes a password hard to guess but easy to remember?

## Exit ticket

- One rule for a strong passphrase + one thing I never share.

**Try it in class tomorrow**
Build passphrases from word cards: Put 20 everyday words on paper scraps in a bag. Pupils pull out three and draw one silly picture linking them — a practice passphrase. Ask which is easier to remember: this or “Xq7#pL2!”. Remind them real passphrases stay secret: never share a password, PIN or code.

Worksheet · for pupils

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

**1** **Which password would be hardest for a guessing program?**

◯ P@ssw0rd! ◯ 12345678 ◯ tomato ladder volcano ◯ Okafor@1990

**2** **Which of these should you never share — even with someone friendly?**

☐ Your school's office phone number ☐ Your mobile money PIN ☐ Your email password

☐ The name of your bank ☐ The one-time code just sent to your phone

**3** **You should change all your passwords every month.**

◯ True ◯ False

**4** **Match each habit to why it helps.**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Three random words | • • • • | No need to reuse one password |
| Its own email password | • • • • | Nobody else can log in as you |
| A list kept safe at home | • • • • | Long, hard to guess, easy to remember |
| Never sharing a code | • • • • | A leak elsewhere can't open your email |

**5** **Complete the sentence.**

A strong passphrase is three _____ words, kept different for your _____ and mobile money, and never _____.

**Word bank:** short · symbols · email · random · shared

Answers · for the teacher

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**1** **tomato ladder volcano**

Three random words are long, unpredictable and easy to picture.

**2** **Your mobile money PIN; The one-time code just sent to your phone; Your email password**

Your PIN lets anyone move your money, the one-time code lets someone sign in or approve a payment as you, and your email password lets them read your mail and reset your other passwords.

**3** **False**

Change a password when there are signs it was stolen or shared.

**4** **Three random words — Long, hard to guess, easy to remember**
**Its own email password — A leak elsewhere can't open your email**
**A list kept safe at home — No need to reuse one password**
**Never sharing a code — Nobody else can log in as you**

Each habit closes a different door: guessing, leaks, reuse and tricks.

**5** **A strong passphrase is three random words, kept different for your email and mobile money, and never shared.**

Random words, a separate email password, and never shared — the three habits in one line.

## For you to think about

**Which of your accounts will you give its own passphrase first, and why? (Don't type the passphrase here.)**